Karen Organization of America; Website Content Draft

Six pages: Home, About, Our Mission, Programs, Advocacy, Donate, Contact.

1. Home

Eyebrow: Karen Organization of America

Headline: Standing with the Karen community in America, both here and beyond borders.

Subhead: Preserving Karen language across generations, promoting appreciation for cultural identity, and providing a voice for those in Kawthoolei and Burma through advocacy in Washington.

Primary CTA: Support our work (→ Donate) **Secondary CTA:** Get involved (→ Programs)

Quick-facts sidebar (for a hero panel or stat strip):

- 3 core pillars: resettlement, civic engagement, cultural preservation
- Active federal advocacy, including the BRAVE Burma Act
- National Youth Advocacy Program (NYAP) for the next generation

Section: What we do

Intro copy: KOA's work spans direct support for newly resettled families, civic and cultural programming that keeps Karen identity strong, and policy advocacy that carries Karen voices into U.S. government decisions on Myanmar/Burma.

Three pillar cards:

1. **Education Program** -Helping Karen families navigate life in a new country, from early arrival needs to longer-term community connection.
2. **Civic engagement & culture** - Karen New Year celebrations, Karen literacy/language classes/resources, and civic programs that pass identity and participation on to the next generation.
3. **Policy advocacy** - Engaging Congress and federal agencies on legislation and policy affecting Myanmar/Burma and the Karen people, including the BRAVE Burma Act.

4. **Education Training -** Guidance for navigating through college readiness, directing to academic resources, job applications/interview preparation, citizenship testing, lawful awareness, English literacy/language classes/resources.

Section: Federal advocacy spotlight

Copy: KOA carries the concerns of the Karen community directly to Congress and federal agencies — from humanitarian access along the Thai–Myanmar border to legislation like the BRAVE Burma Act.

Pull quote: "The Karen community's story doesn't end at resettlement — it continues in the decisions Washington makes about Myanmar/Burma." — Karen Organization of America

Section: Youth program spotlight

Copy: NYAP connects young Karen Americans with the skills, history, and networks they need to carry the community's advocacy forward — in their own communities and in the halls of government.

CTA card: Get involved — Volunteer, join a chapter event, or bring KOA to speak with your community group. (→ Contact)

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2. About

Headline: Rooted in community, built for the long term.

Subhead: The Karen Organization of America exists to support Karen families in the U.S. and to carry the Karen community's voice into national policy regarding Myanmar (Burma).

Our mission

Our approach

We work at three levels at once: direct, practical support for individuals and families; community and cultural programming that keeps identity strong; and policy engagement in Washington, D.C. that connects community experience to legislation and federal decision-making.

Our values

- **Community first** — Programs and advocacy priorities are shaped by what Karen families and community members actually need.

- **Cultural continuity** — Language, tradition, and history are treated as living things worth actively passing on, not just preserving.
- **Principled advocacy** — We engage government processes directly and transparently, on behalf of the community we represent.

Leadership

[Add leadership bios here — Executive Director, board chair, and other key staff, with photos and short backgrounds.]

Suggested format per person:

- Name
- Title
- 2–3 sentence bio (background, why this work, one personal detail)

Our history — milestones

[Replace with KOA's actual founding date and key milestones. Suggested structure below.]

- **[Year]** — Founding of the Karen Organization of America and its original mission.
- **[Year]** — A major program launch (e.g. the National Youth Advocacy Program).
- **[Year]** — A significant federal advocacy milestone.

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3. Programs

Headline: Support that meets people where they are.

Subhead: From a family's first months in a new country to the next generation's civic leadership, KOA's programs cover the full arc of community life.

What this looks like: [Describe specific services — e.g. orientation sessions, interpretation support, referrals to partner agencies, English language resources.]

Civic engagement & cultural preservation

Copy: We run cultural events, language classes, and civic programming that help Karen Americans stay connected to their heritage while participating fully in American civic life.

Tags: Language classes · Cultural events · Civic participation

Karen New Year callout: [Describe the annual Karen New Year celebration — date, format, and how the community gathers.]

National Youth Advocacy Program (NYAP)

Copy: NYAP gives young Karen Americans the history, advocacy skills, and networks to represent their community — from local civic life to federal policy conversations in Washington, D.C.

Program elements (fill in specifics):

- [Leadership training and workshops]
- [Community history and civics curriculum]
- [Direct advocacy experience, e.g. meeting with policymakers]
- [Mentorship and peer network]

Closing CTA: Want to bring a program to your community? Reach out and we'll help figure out what fits. (→ Contact)

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4. Advocacy

Headline: Carrying Karen voices into U.S. policy.

Subhead: KOA engages Congress and federal agencies directly on legislation and policy affecting Myanmar/Burma and the Karen people — and helps community members make their own voices heard.

Current priority: The BRAVE Burma Act

The BRAVE Burma Act (H.R. 3190) passed the U.S. House of Representatives on February 9, 2026. KOA has been engaging members of Congress and their staff to build support for the bill and explain what it would mean for the Karen people and the broader situation in Myanmar/Burma.

[Add a plain-language summary of what the BRAVE Burma Act does and why it matters, once finalized.]

Status table: | Milestone | Date | |---|---| | Passed U.S. House | Feb 9, 2026 | | [Next step, e.g. Senate action] | [Date / TBD] |

How we work — federal engagement

KOA meets with congressional offices, participates in briefings, and shares community perspective on legislation and policy affecting Myanmar/Burma — including humanitarian access along the Thai–Myanmar border.

- **Congressional meetings** — Direct meetings with representatives and staff to explain community priorities and legislative asks.
- **Cross-border engagement** — Coordination with humanitarian partners working along the Thai–Myanmar border.
- **Public education** — Helping policymakers and the public understand the history and current reality facing the Karen people.

Take action

- **Contact your representative** — **[Add a simple guide or template for reaching out to a member of Congress.]**
- **Join a briefing** — **[List upcoming public briefings or webinars, if applicable.]**
- **Support the work** — Advocacy travel, briefings, and staff time all rely on community support. (→ Donate)

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5. Donate

Headline: Your support funds the whole mission.

Subhead: Gifts to KOA go directly toward resettlement support, cultural programming, youth leadership, and advocacy travel to Washington, D.C.

Suggested giving amounts: $25 / $50 / $100 / $250, plus a custom amount field. **Note: [Connect the donate button to a payment processor — e.g. Stripe, PayPal Giving, or Donorbox — before publishing.]**

Where your gift goes

- **Resettlement support** — case navigation and direct family assistance.
- **Cultural preservation** — Karen New Year, language classes, community events.
- **Youth advocacy** — National Youth Advocacy Program training and mentorship.
- **Federal advocacy** — travel and staff time for congressional engagement, including work on the BRAVE Burma Act.

Other ways to give

- Mail a check to: **[Add mailing address]**
- Employer matching gifts: **[Add instructions if applicable]**
- Recurring monthly giving: **[Add details]**
- In-kind or planned gifts: contact us to discuss

Tax disclosure

[Add your 501(c)(3) tax-exemption language and EIN once confirmed — e.g. "KOA is a tax-exempt nonprofit organization under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. Donations are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law. EIN: XX-XXXXXXX."]

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6. Contact

Headline: We'd like to hear from you.

Subhead: Whether you need resettlement support, want to volunteer, or represent a congressional office, reach out below.

Contact form fields (suggested) Do this for every event coordinator

- Full name
- Email address
- Reason for contact (dropdown): Resettlement support / Volunteering / Programs & events / Advocacy or policy / Media inquiry / Feature Request / Other
- Message | Email (need to set up business emails how to do that and put what inquiries or conversations are for whom)

Note: [The form needs a backend — e.g. Formspree, Netlify Forms, or a mail API — to actually deliver messages.] What about my Cloudflare setup?

Other ways to reach us

Mailing address	**[Add address]**
Phone	**[Add phone number]**
Email	**[Add email address]**

Office hours	**[Add hours]**

Follow along

- **facebook.com/koamerica**
- **ig.koamerica**
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Footer copy (repeats on every page)

Org blurb: preserving culture, and advocating for the Karen people in Myanmar/Burma.

Explore: About KOA · Programs · Advocacy **Connect:** Contact us · Donate • Upcoming **Reach us: [mailing address]** · **[phone number]** · **[email address]**

Copyright line: © 2026 Karen Organization of America. All rights zzz. **Legal note: [Add 501(c)(3) / EIN disclosure]**

Open items before this goes live

- Leadership names, titles, and bios (About)
- Founding date and 2–3 real historical milestones (About)
- Karen New Year event details (Programs)
- NYAP program elements, confirmed (Programs)
- Plain-language BRAVE Burma Act summary + next legislative step (Advocacy)
- Congressional contact guide/template (Advocacy)
- Payment processor decision (Donate)
- 501(c)(3)/EIN language (Donate, Footer)
- Mailing address, phone, email, office hours (Contact, Footer)
- Social media links (Contact, Footer)